

Aknur Zhakanova

4th year B. S. student in Geology

✉ aknur.zhakanova@nu.edu.kz ☎ +77711644997

SUMMARY

Fourth-year B.Sc. Geology student at Nazarbayev University. Experienced in core logging, lithogeochemical sampling, geological mapping, and fieldwork across porphyry systems and sedimentary basins in Central Asia. Skilled in 3D geological modeling, GIS, and thin-section analysis. Presenter at the PDAC–SEG Student Minerals Colloquium 2026.

EXPERIENCE

Nazarbayev University - Research Assistant

October 2025 - current

- Worked with Professor Mahmoud Leila to the projects related with H2 extraction and CO2 injection to ultramafic rocks in reactor.
- Validated and corrected ML-derived geospatial polygons in QGIS.

Pallas Resources - Field Geologist

February 2026 - August 2026

- Conducted geological core logging, core orientation, and drilling-control measurements across ~3 km of diamond drilling in a remote exploration program in Central Kazakhstan.
- Completed a 3-month field campaign supporting drill-hole quality control and geological documentation.

Kazakhmys Barlau - Geologist

June 2025 - August 2025

- Carried out lithogeochemical sampling and applied QA/QC procedures on one of the largest porphyry deposits in Central Asia.
- Prepared geological maps and figures in ArcGIS, AutoCAD, and CorelDRAW; managed sampling and drillhole data in acQuire.

National Geological Survey NGS - Geologist

May 2025 - June 2025

- Analyzed Soviet-era geological reports to identify prospective extraction sites.
- Compiled interpretative summaries to support resource evaluation and exploration planning.

ERG - Geologist

December 2024 - February 2025

- Built 3D geological models in Micromine from historical records.
- Digitized and structured geological data in Excel to support modeling and interpretation.

EDUCATION

B.Sc. in Geology

Nazarbayev University - Astana - 2023-2027

CERTIFICATIONS

- Volunteering at Central Asia Water Conference 2025
- Volunteering at Nazarbayev University, Open House Day 2025
- Certificate for the 2nd place - Winner of the Satbayev Geological Universiade 2025.
- Speaker at the Student Colloquium **PDAC 2026**, Toronto, Canada.

COURSEWORK

- Educational field trips, West, East, and Southern Kazakhstan, 2024–2026 - applied coursework in structural geology, sedimentary geology, and petroleum geology.
- PDAC 2026 short course: Public Geoscience and Geodata Science-Based Mineral Exploration (Orange Data Mining), Toronto.
- Professional development seminar: Mineralization Modeling for Grade Control in Micromine and Leapfrog, 2025.

SKILLS

- Core logging, core orientation, lithogeochemical sampling, QA/QC, geological mapping, thin-section analysis, remote sensing, 3D geological modeling
- QGIS, ArcGIS, acQuire, Micromine, AutoCAD, CorelDRAW, Excel, LeapFrog, Petrel

Languages

English: Advanced (IELTS 7.5) | Kazakh: Native | Russian: Advanced | Turkish: Intermediate | Arabic: Beginner